

Kathy Hendricks is a retired clarinetist from the Memphis Symphony. She moved to Hot Springs Village in 2017 after retiring from Shelby County Schools in Memphis. After 30 years as a teacher and assistant principal, she concluded her career as principal of the International Baccalaureate Primary Program at the World School in Memphis. Prior to her education career, Hendricks performed with the Memphis Symphony and the Memphis, Dallas and Texas Wind Symphonies. She is currently principal clarinetist in the Hot Springs Concert Band and saxophonist in the Village Big Band.

Diane Kesling is a mezzo-soprano whose musical career has included distinguished engagements with a number of the world's leading opera houses including the Metropolitan Opera, l'Opéra de Nice, Houston Grand Opera and the Kennedy Center. Kesling is a graduate of Ohio State University, the Houston Opera Studio and the Metropolitan Opera's Young Artist Program.

Kristen La Madrid earned a B.A. in Piano from La Sierra University and an M.M. in Collaborative Piano from the University of Miami. She currently coordinates the staff accompanists at Ouachita Baptist University and serves as pianist, organist, and choir director at Bonnerdale Seventh-Day Adventist Church and Westminster Presbyterian Church. She teaches private piano lessons and collaborates with the Muses Creative Artistry Project, the Pocket Community Theatre, and the Stardust Big Band.

Rowan Moser is a native of Clay County and a junior at the Arkansas School for Mathematics, Science, and the Arts.

Elsen Portugal is a pianist, an ethnodoxologist, and a professor and vice president of Academic Affairs at Champion Christian College. He holds a PhD in Ethnodoxology from B.H. Carroll Theological Institute, and Master's degrees in Piano Performance and Missions, as well as a Bachelor's in Piano Pedagogy. Since the 1980s, he has served as minister of music, a missionary in Germany, Costa Rica and Brazil, as well as professor and collaborative pianist. Since 2010, his focus has been the application of local (indigenous) music and arts in worship and other intercultural communications.

Mary Ritch, French horn, has lived, studied and played across the U.S. and abroad, including the University of Missouri-Kansas City Conservatory, the San Francisco Conservatory, and the University of Southern California, where she earned her Master's and Doctoral degrees in performance. Since relocating to Hot Springs Village in 2021, she has performed with the Natural State Brass Band, Little Rock Winds, and the Hot Springs Concert Band. She also founded the Hot Springs Horn Ensemble, performs in chamber music recitals throughout the region, and serves on the Board of the Hot Springs/Hot Springs Village Symphony Guild, where she directs its Classic Concert Series and educational outreach programs.

The Hot Springs Music Connection raises money to provide scholarships to students from Garland County who are pursuing music-related degrees in college. HSMC is affiliated with the National Federation of Music Clubs, which provides opportunities for musical study, performance, and appreciation to more than 90,000 senior, student, and junior members in 5,200 music-related clubs and organizations nationwide. It is chartered by the Congress of the United States and is the only music organization member of the United Nations.

Dedicated to finding and fostering young musical talent, the NFMC conducts annual Junior Festivals with approximately 100,000 participants. It offers more than three quarters of a million dollars in state and national competitions, including four \$20,000 biennial Young Artist awards, and the \$20,000 Ellis Award for Duo-Pianists. The Young Artist and Ellis Duo Piano awards include two years of performance bookings.



HOT SPRINGS MUSIC CONNECTION

OCTOBER INTERLUDES

A CHAMBER MUSIC CELEBRATION

2025-2026 Season

St. Mary's Catholic Church Parish Hall
October 5, 2025
3:00 p.m.



October Interludes: A Chamber Music Celebration



Welcome and Introductions Dr. Tom Bolton, President

Program Introduction Dr. Tish Kennedy Davenport, Chair

Program

Spider Suite Jenni Brandon (b. 1977)

1. Along came a spider . . .
2. The Spider's Flight
3. Spinning Song
4. A Wicked Waltz: The Spider and the Happy Bug
(unsuspecting)
5. The end of the day . . . begin again

Susan Antonetti, *flute*
Janice Bengston, *clarinet*
Jason Brannon, *bassoon*

Trio for Clarinet, Horn and Piano Carl Reinecke (1824-1910)

Dr. Mary Ritch, *French horn*
Kathy Hendricks, *clarinet*
Dr. Elsen Portugal, *piano*

From Twelve Duets KV487 W. A. Mozart (1756-1791)
Numbers II, III, V, IX, XI

Rowan Moser, *trumpet*
Cody A. Ford, *euphonium*

Trio Sonata in B-flat Major Georg Philipp Telemann (1681-1767)

Susanna Arteaga, *violin*
Dr. Tish Kennedy Davenport, *flute*
Kristen La Madrid, *piano*

Two Songs Leonard Bernstein (1918-1990)

1. A Simple Song (from *Mass*)
2. Quiet Place (from *Trouble in Tahiti*)

Diane Kesling, *mezzo-soprano*
Dr. Elsen Portugal, *piano*
Dr. Tish Kennedy Davenport, *flute*

“Ballade” (from Ballade, Pastorale and Dance) Eric Ewazen (b. 1954)

Susan Antonetti, *flute*
Dr. Mary Ritch, *French horn*
Dr. Elsen Portugal, *piano*



Today's Performers

Susan Antonetti is a retired high school band director and former adjunct instructor of flute at the University of Arkansas at Little Rock and Harding University. She now teaches flute in the Little Rock area using the Suzuki method. She is principal piccoloist with the Little Rock Winds, co-directs the Alchemia Flute Ensemble, and holds degrees from Arkansas Tech University and the University of Arkansas at Fayetteville.

Susanna Arteaga is a Hot Springs native who attended college in Kansas City, where she received a performance degree and studied with a violinist from the Kansas City Symphony. She is a stay-at-home mom with three boys, teaches violin, and on Sundays plays a traditional and contemporary service at St. Andrew's Anglican Church in Little Rock.

Janice Bengston is a former U.S. Air Force clarinetist with more than 20 years of performance, touring and recording experience, including Grammy-winning projects. After a career as a band director, she now focuses on clarinet performance, serving as principal clarinetist of the Little Rock Winds and bass clarinetist with the Arkansas C4 Clarinet Quartet. She holds a Bachelor's in Music Education from the University of South Florida and a Master's and Specialist's degrees in Educational Leadership.

Jason Brannon is a bassoonist with the Little Rock Winds, where he also serves as librarian. He works in data engineering at First Orion in North Little Rock.

Tish Kennedy Davenport graduated with a Bachelor of Music from Loyola University, after which she joined the Marine Corps, serving four years as a flautist and pianist. She received a Master of Music degree and Ph.D. in Music Theory with a secondary in Choral Conducting from the University of North Texas. She is currently the Director of Traditional Music Ministries at Hot Springs First United Methodist Church.

Cody Ford directs the Wind Ensemble at the Arkansas School for Mathematics, Sciences, and the Arts and teaches brass, percussion and Music Studio classes. His educational background includes a Bachelor of Music in Euphonium Performance from Louisiana Tech University, a Bachelor of Music Education with a concentration in Instrumental Education K-12 from the University of Central Arkansas, and a Master of Music with a concentration in Wind Conducting from UCA.